

Master Vocabulary Guide: IELTS

Listening Part 2

Topic: Social Monologues (e.g., Tour Guides, Radio Talks, Employee Inductions)

Section A: Location & Direction (Map Labeling)

Essential for map and plan labeling tasks.

1. Prepositions of Place

Speaker Says	Synonym / Visual Clue
Next to / Beside / By	Adjacent to / Adjoining / Bordering
Opposite / Facing	Across from
Behind	At the rear of / At the back
In the middle of	Central / In the center of
At the entrance	In the foyer / Reception area / Lobby
Runs alongside	Parallel to
Intersects with	Crosses / Meets / Junction
Circular	Ring-shaped

2. Movement & Directions

- **Go straight on:** Proceed / Continue ahead / Move forward.
- **Turn:** Bend / Curve / Take a sharp right/left.
- **Go past:** Pass by / Go beyond.
- **Cross:** Go over (bridge) / Go through.
- **Dead end:** No through road / Cul-de-sac.
- **Winding road:** Curvy / Sinuous path.

3. Structural Features (Landmarks)

- **Corridor:** Hallway / Passage.
- **Foyer:** Lobby / Entrance hall.
- **Amenities:** Facilities (toilets, cafe, gift shop).
- **Footpath:** Pavement / Sidewalk / Trail.

Section B: Changes & Renovations

Used when comparing the past to the present (e.g., "The library has changed...").

Describing the Change	Meaning / Synonym
Demolished	Knocked down / Removed / Flattened
Expanded	Enlarged / Extended / Made bigger
Renovated	Refurbished / Modernized / Updated / Redecorated
Converted	Turned into / Repurposed (e.g., "Office turned into a gym")
Relocated	Moved to a different place / Shifted
Replaced	Substituted / Exchanged

Section C: Events, Tourism & Activities

4. Booking & Attendance

Vocabulary	Synonyms
Book / Reserve	Secure a spot / Make a reservation
Register	Enrol / Sign up / Join
Available	Vacant / Free / Open
Fully booked	No seats left / Sold out / At capacity
Cancel	Call off
Postpone	Put off / Delay / Reschedule

5. Money & Cost

- **Cost:** Price / Fee / Charge / Rate / Tariff.
- **Entrance Fee:** Admission / Entry charge.
- **Discount:** Reduction / Concession (often for students/seniors).
- **Refund:** Reimbursement / Money back.
- **Deposit:** Down payment / Advance.

- **Included:** Covered / Complimentary (Free).

Section D: Common Contexts

6. Work, Volunteering & Training

Common in "New Employee" or "Charity" talks.

Speaker Says	Question Paper Synonym
Boss / Manager	Supervisor / Line Manager / Coordinator
Colleagues	Co-workers / Staff / Personnel / Team
Work hours	Shift pattern / Roster / Schedule
Day off	Leave / Annual leave / Holiday entitlement
Pay	Wage / Salary / Remuneration
Training	Induction / Probation period / Workshop
Skills	Competencies / Expertise / Proficiency

7. Rules, Safety & Regulations

Speaker Says	Question Paper Synonym
Not allowed	Prohibited / Banned / Forbidden / Restricted
Must do	Mandatory / Compulsory / Obligatory / Essential
Follow rules	Adhere to / Comply with / Observe regulations
Clothes	Attire / Uniform / Dress code / Protective gear
Danger	Hazard / Risk / Threat
Be careful	Exercise caution / Be vigilant

8. Nature, Parks & Conservation

- **Animals:** Wildlife / Fauna / Livestock (farm animals).
- **Plants:** Vegetation / Flora / Greenery / Shrubs.
- **Home (for animals):** Habitat / Territory / Ecosystem.
- **Protect:** Conserve / Preserve / Safeguard.
- **Farming:** Agriculture / Cultivation.
- **Bugs:** Insects / Pests.

Section E: Descriptive Language

9. Objects & Materials

Used when describing museum artifacts or lost items.

- **Shape:** Cylindrical (tube), Spherical (ball), Rectangular, Curved.
- **Material:** Synthetic (man-made), Fabric/Textiles, Leather, Ceramic, Timber (wood).
- **Condition:** Intact (perfect), Fragile (breaks easily), Scratched, Dented, Pristine.

10. Common Adjectives

Simple Word	IELTS Synonym
Beautiful	Scenic / Picturesque / Breathtaking
Quiet	Peaceful / Tranquil / Serene
Busy	Bustling / Hectic / Vibrant
Old	Historic / Ancient / Heritage
Temporary	Provisional / Short-term
Rare	Unique / Uncommon / Scarce

Section F: Critical Listening Skills

11. Time, Frequency & Numbers

Watch out for these specific time references.

- **Fortnightly:** Every two weeks.
- **Annually:** Once a year.
- **Bi-annual:** Twice a year.
- **Quarterly:** Every three months.
- **Consecutive:** In a row (e.g., "Three consecutive days").
- **Imminent:** Happening very soon.

12. "Distractor" Signals (The Trap Words)

Speakers often mention incorrect answers before the correct one.

Negative Signals (Answer is NO):

- "We **used to** have..." (Past tense).
- "We **originally planned** to..." (Change of plan).
- "Unlike the..."
- "Instead of..."

Positive Signals (Answer is YES):

- "We have **opted for**..."
- "We **settled on**..."
- "Eventually, we..."
- "In the end..."

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